What is Pimento?

PIMENTO
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SAS AU CAPITAL DE 55290€ - WWW.PIMENTODRINK.COM
SIRET 509 633 046 00024 - N° TVA INTRACOMMUNAUTAIRE FR.88.509.633.046 - APE 1107B

Take a sip.
First, the surprise of ginger - full and fruity.
Then, the shock of chili - hot and amazing.
A thrilling heat wave runs through your body.
The unique taste and sensation of Pimento.

You need a second sip. A second experience.

You just won't want any other soft drink from now on!

Pimento, finalist at Innovation Awards @ Drinktec Trade Show, ***Munich***

Pimento, finalist at Food Innovation Awards @ Cervia, ***Paris***

Pimento, Gold Medal @ Great Taste Awards (Guild of Fine Food), ***London***

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I. - TASTING NOTES

Pimento is a unique and innovative beverage made in France. It has a strong taste like an alcoholic drink, yet it contains no alcohol.

This mind-boggling, refreshing fizzy drink is made with ginger, tonic and natural hot pepper flavours (plus bitter orange, lime, oregano and gentian natural flavours). It is low in sugar, very spicy and full of taste.

The first sip is very full and fruity with a ginger aroma and a twist of citrus, followed by a growing taste of hot pepper that makes this drink totally unique.

Further sips are softer and rounder because of the ginger, but not too sweet.
This low-sugar, alcohol-free spicy ginger ale is an exciting experience.

The drink produces an amazing kick, and tastes like alcohol, but it's not!

The chilli pepper comes from Jamaica and the ginger from China and Ivory Coast (Africa).

II. - PRODUCTION

The flavours are produced by Expression Aromatiques in Grasse - the famous city of perfumers and flavourists, located in South of France.

The chilli pepper comes from Jamaica and the ginger from China and Ivory Coast (Africa).

Pimento is bottled in Saverne (near Strasbourg in eastern France) by La Licorne (Karsbrau - Karlsberg Group), one of the biggest French breweries.

The main warehouse is in Torcy, 30km from Paris (Zip code: 77).

The head office of Pimento is located in the center of Paris at 14, avenue de l'Opéra – 75001.

Pimento is produced in a similar way to other bottled sodas: flavours + sugars + citric acid + carbonated water.

Pimento contains 30% less sugar than classic sodas. The recipe includes 2 sweeteners: Acesulfame K + Sucralose to soften the drink's natural strong and bitter notes without adding too many calories.

Acesulfame K + Sucralose are among the best sweeteners for beverages and they are totally safe. European law requires the use of 2 sweeteners - in combination they produce a greater

sweetening effect. (Unfortunately it is not possible to use the new sweetener, Stevia as this imparts an aniseed taste).

III. - APPELLATION

It is important to understand the differences between **ginger ale** and **ginger beer**. Traditionally these are not made with either ale or beer!

For the record, a **ginger ale** is a soda made with a low ginger content.
(One of the first was Canada Dry, created in Canada in 1905).

On the other hand, a **ginger beer** is a soda made with a higher ginger content.
It is called « beer » because in the past, these « Indian » beverages were brewed with fresh & fermented ginger. The production process is highly complex because ginger roots vary significantly and produce cloudy beverages with a short shelf life.

These days, except for some extremely rare home made products, most ginger "beers" are actually made like ginger ale, i.e. they are produced like a soda / lemonade: flavours + sugar/sweeteners + carbonated water.

Pimento is thus both a (spicy) ginger beer and… a (spicy) ginger ale!

For Anglo-Saxons, Scandinavians and people from Commonwealth nations, Pimento is undoubtedly perceived as a ginger beer. Most of them have nostalgia for the traditional very strong & highly spicy products originating in India. That's why they enjoy Pimento so much.

To be more poetic, we could say that the fruity tasting, highly-flavoured and beautifully spicy Pimento is the natural child of an Anglo-Indian ginger beer and an African ginger juice.

IV. – COMPETITIVE PRODUCTS

To make a great cocktail, bartenders need good spirits, but above all they need good soft drinks that are going to blend well with the spirits and enhance them. In fine mixology, only ginger ale and ginger beer do this job.

The main competitors to Pimento are:

Ginger ale
- Canada Dry (very low ginger content - between Sprite & 7 Up)
- Schweppes Ale (weak tasting)

Main Ginger beer
- Fever Tree (UK)

- Fentimans (UK)
- Luscombe (UK)
- John Crabbies (UK)
- Thomas Henry (Germany)
- Bundaberg (Germany)
- Goldberg (Belgium)
- Reeds (USA)
- Bruce Cost (USA)

Cheap ginger beers

- Old Jamaica (highly sweet)
- Elephant (highly sweet)

Although Pimento is part of this ginger drinks family, there really is no comparison.
It is more fruity, deeply yummy and spicy (the kick!). Above all, Pimento works really well neat, “on-the-rocks” - most of its competitors are thin, extremely bitter and really just designed as mixers for a limited range of spirits.

It is worth noting that some bartenders make their own ginger beers. However, these are mostly super-strong, very bitter, and not stable.

Tasted neat in blind tests with competitors, Pimento wins every time.

Mixologists prefer Pimento because its chilli pepper really enhances the flavours of spirits such as rum, vodka or tequila. Moreover in a mix, the spirit slightly softens the kick of Pimento - the drink is still hot and “caliente”, but a little bit gentler on the palate.

A competitive copy review is available on request.

V. – TARGETS

Targets : 2 kinds of consumers:

- “Adults” that appreciate Pimento neat - as a kind of alcohol alternative. The drink produces an amazing kick, and tastes like alcohol, but it’s not! Pimento is perfect for people who don’t drink alcohol or who think that classic sodas lack any real flavour.

- “Youngs” who like their cocktails spiced up with Pimento. Bartenders prefer Pimento because its chili pepper really enhances the flavours of spirits. Pimento has partnered with the French Association of Barmen (ABF) and it’s true that the drink can be mixed in mocktails & cocktails. The beverage is arguably the most versatile mixer there is - not only perfect with a wide range of spirits including vodka, rum, gin, tequila, brandy, Armagnac, whisky, cognac, bourbon, calvados, Jägermeister, Chartreuse, cachaça, absinthe and sake, but also beer, prosecco and champagne!

Of course, these reasons are not “exclusive” to these targets.

Moreover, Pimento is a ready, natural accompaniment for many of the world’s foods - perfect with South-American, Asian, Scandinavian, Mexican, Indian, Anglo-Saxon, African, Spanish or Middle-East cuisines.

It is interesting to note that a growing number of leading chefs use Pimento to cook - deglazing gambas, shrimps or chicken fillets and creating marvellous sauces or innovative desserts (Granita).

VI. – BUSINESS

As I have written here above, Pimento is appreciated neat and mixed - and we are not far from the Red Bull case.

A) Mixed: the buzz opportunity

Many distributors work on on-trade at first to create some buzz and build a strong awareness as huge.

Plenty of bartenders have created cocktails with Pimento and I can send you all the recipes on request.

The main uses for Pimento are as follows:

- Neat (on the rocks with lime)
- Mixed with fruit juices
- Spice Beer (Pimento + beer)
- (Virgin) Spicy Mojito (Pimento to replace the sparkling water)
- Hot Mule (Pimento + Vodka + lime)
- Spicy ‘n’ Stormy (Pimento + dark/spiced rum + lime + Angostura)
- Hot Bomb (Jägermeister + Pimento)

Note that Pimento is especially delicious mixed with a dark rum and lime. Rums such as Captain Morgan, Sailor Jerry, Gosling, Brugal or Kraken are currently very on-trend throughout the world and their flavours are really enhanced when mixed with a good ginger beer.

A Pimento / Jägermeister mix is also a beautiful marriage of strong, yet complementary fruit and botanical flavours.

At last, Pimento is a pleasure to mix with a vodka or a gin (particularly trendy these last months…).

If you like rum and Pimento, you'll love « A Mountain of Crushed Ice », the famous blog written by Helena Tiare Olsen from Stockholm.

Check out www.amountainofcrushedice.com/?p=17588
and www.amountainofcrushedice.com/?p=17700

A Mountain of Crushed Ice is all about rum, tiki drinks and more. Apart from being a member of the International Rum Expert Panel, Helena is also a member of the Mixoloseum and the Cocktails and Spirits Online Writers Group (CSOWG)

For a pub or bar, Pimento offers a wider range of money-making opportunities than a traditional soft drink.

Mixed in a cocktail or mocktail, the beverage intensifies flavours. Consumed neat, Pimento can be slowly savoured like a real virgin cocktail full of taste.

This is why plenty of bars are able to use Pimento to increase their selling prices and margins without any negative feedback from their customers. I can forward you some typical retail prices.

Note that the Pimento bottle has a twist-off screw-cap which allows barmen to re-seal and return the bottle to the fridge for further use.

Moreover, Pimento is a ready, natural accompaniment for many of the world's foods – perfect with Asian, Scandinavian, Mexican, Indian, Anglo-Saxon, African, Spanish or Middle-East cuisines.

It is interesting to note that a growing number of leading chefs use Pimento to cook - deglazing gambas, shrimps or chicken fillets and creating marvellous sauces and innovative desserts (Granita).

B) Neat: the big potential

Pimento is successfully surfing the current worldwide wave of popular demand for ginger ale & ginger beer.

It is perfect for people who don't drink alcohol or who think that classic sodas lack any real flavour.

FYI, the beverage is particularly appreciated by Muslims who have a deep and ancient ginger and chilli culture/tradition.

The neat consumption is the best one for sales and volume.

VII. – INSIGHT

Insight
The best insight could be the following:

" When I want to drink something good, alcohol-free, powerful and refreshing, I don't know what to order. Traditional sodas (Coke, Fanta, Orangina….) are tasteless, ***regressive****, classic and too sweet. They are definitely not for me."*

The main benefit could be something like:

"At least a sweet drink and so violent at the same time. This beverage is increasingly new."

Reason why:
- Sweet and Strong, as the first sip of Pimento. Sweet & fruity at first (ginger), then strong & spicy (chili).
- Double impact: physical & mental

=> You'll love the kick.

VIII. – COMMERCIAL STRATEGY

The commercial strategy is linked to the awareness of ginger ale & ginger beer in the considered country, also ginger and chilli pepper ingredients.

If this beverage's family and its ingredients is not famous, we launch first in on-trade (France, Italy, Greece, Germany, Czech Republic, Hungary…).

If these drinks + ingredients are known, we launch on-trade and off-trade both and it's obviously better for sales (UK, USA, Australia…).

IX. – PARTNERSHIP

Most of the importers organize cross brandings (events, sampling) with spirits that they distribute - or not.

UK: Ron Cubay, Beluga vodka.
France: Beluga vodka, Jungfrau (Jagermeister competitor), Ypioca Cachaça, Blackwell rum, Sailor Jerry rum, Mount Gay rum, National Association of Cognac (Brandy).
Italy: Roby Marton Gin
Czech Republic: Capitan Bucanero elixir, Monin syrups
Etc…

X. – BAR BUSINESS MODEL

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This why plenty of bars are able to use Pimento to increase their selling prices and margins without any negative feedback from their customers. Here are some typical retail prices:

- Pimento 25cl: €2,80 to €4,80
- Glass of Pimento (1/2 bottle => 12,5cl) on the rocks: €2,30 to €2,50
- Spicy juices (+ apple, grapefruit, strawberry juice etc…): + €1 to €2
- Mojito Pimento (to replace the sparkling water): + €1 to €3
- Chili Beer (serve Pimento like a syrup): + €1
- Hot Mule (+ vodka & lime): + €1 to €3
- Hot Bomb: + €1 to €2
- Spicy & Stormy (+ dark rum & lime): + €1 to €3
- Shooters (50/50): +€0,50

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XI. – TARGET OUTLETS

Licensed/"On-Trade"/HORECA:

- Pubs (for cocktails & shots)
- Anglo-Saxon bars (including USA - Tex Mex, Canada). Commonwealth (UK, Irish, Scottish, Australia, New-Zealand), & Scandinavian outlets.
- Luxury hotel bars & lounges.
- Restaurants
- Fast food and takeaways (Asian, Mexican, pizzas & burgers).
- "Ethnic" restaurants - chicken, kebabs etc…
- Cafes and delicatessens

Retail/"Off-trade":

- Fine grocery stores
- Selected supermarkets

XII. – FRANCE & EXPORT

Pimento was launched in the beginning of March 2009 in Paris and its reception has been an immediate and resounding success: +600 selective POS now in France, mainly in on-trade.

Tradelink distributes Pimento in France. Check out www.tradelink.fr

We develop Pimento in a national way and the biggest wholesalers of each area deliver the beverage.

After a great response at the 2013 Anuga trade show, Pimento is expanding its distribution worldwide. Pimento will have a stand at Sial 2014.

It is already in the USA, UK, Germany, Belgium, Denmark, Czech Republic, Hungary, Switzerland, Italy, Greece, Caribbean, Pacific, Africa, Singapore, Thailand and India.

We are on discussion with many other importers (Japan, Sweden, China, Indonesia, Morocco, Middle East, Brazil, Mexico etc…).

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